Block practice · The brain and neuropsychology

Work through each question type in order. Each section has a worked-example retry and all further practice. Attempt only the part outlined in red.

Lobes of the brain and the cerebellum

Neurons, synapses and the central nervous system

Left and right hemispheres, corpus callosum and sex differences

Damasio et al. (1994): the return of Phineas Gage

Sperry (1968): split-brain patients

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Practice workbook · Lobes of the brain and the cerebellum

Structure and function of the frontal, temporal, parietal and occipital lobes and the cerebellum.

6 question parts: 1 worked-example retry and 5 further practice parts.
Name: _____ Class: _____ Date: _____

Practise one question type at a time. Attempt the part inside the red boundary; the rest of the question and any figures are kept for context. Write your working in the answer space.

The first question is a retry of the website worked example, without its solution. Check your answers online with 'Check my answer', or ask your teacher for the answer booklet.

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Type ID: PSY-BRN-01

1. Question 17 · part a · 2 marks

2025 JUN · Paper 01

Worked-example retry · Attempt part a only.

17 Sandy has been asked to investigate the function of 'Region G' of the brain.

She decides to give some tests to one of her female patients who has damaged 'Region G' of their brain:

- Colour naming test: The patient is asked to name what colour they see when presented with a coloured piece of paper.
- Recall test: The patient is asked to recall the months of the year in order and when they were born.
- Pressure test: Physical pressure is applied to the patient when they are blindfolded and they have to say where they can feel the pressure being applied.

The patient performed well on the recall test and pressure test but performed poorly on the colour naming test.

(a) Explain which region of the brain the patient is likely to have damaged from their performance in the tests.

You should refer to the function of the damaged region in your answer.

(2)

(b) Explain **one** improvement Sandy could have made to her investigation.

(2)

(Total for Question 17 = 4 marks)

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1. Question 17 · part a · 2 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

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2. Question 17 · part whole · 4 marks

2021 NOV · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part whole only.

17 Malvina was investigating the role of different brain regions.

She organised for three groups of participants to carry out two tasks.

All the participants in group 1 had damage to region X of the brain. All the participants in group 2 had damage to region Y of the brain. A control group (group 3) had no damage to their brain.

All groups were required to carry out two tasks.

- Task 1: To walk along a narrow balance beam without touching the floor below.
- Task 2: To look at 10 images of common household objects and name them.

The average scores of the participants are shown in **Table 2**.

Group	Task 1: Beam task (number of times they touched the floor)	Task 2: Image task (number of objects correctly named out of 10)
Group 1 average score	16	10
Group 2 average score	1	1
Group 3 average score	1	10

Table 2

OLevels.COM SCHOOL

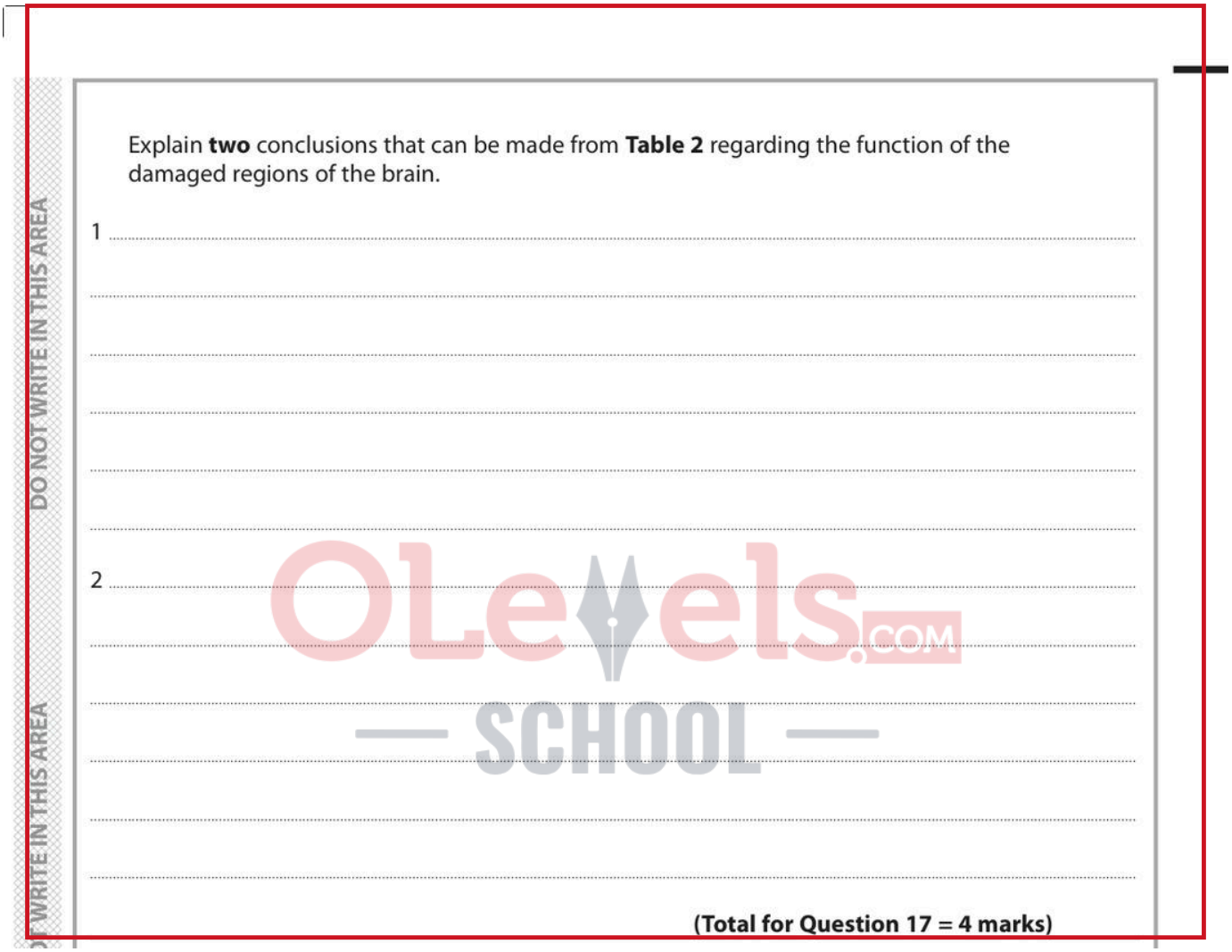
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P 6 5 4 4 5 A 0 2 2 4 0

2. Question 17 · part whole · 4 marks

2021 NOV · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part whole only.



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Explain **two** conclusions that can be made from **Table 2** regarding the function of the damaged regions of the brain.

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(Total for Question 17 = 4 marks)

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2. Question 17 · part whole · 4 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

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3. Question 20 · part whole · 2 marks

2021 NOV · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part whole only.

20 Five patients with damage to a region of the brain were investigated by Lynne. The brain lobe damaged is shown in **Figure 4**.

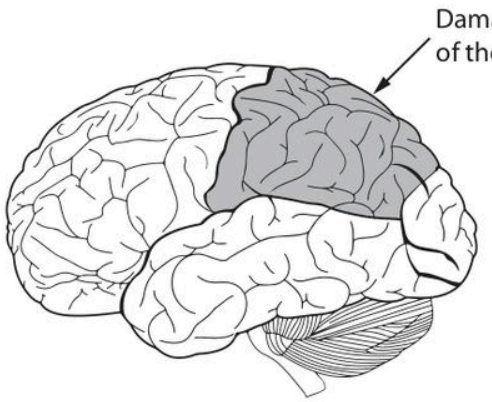


Figure 4

She gave them tasks involving problem solving, pain, and memory.

The tasks were:

- Problem solving: solve 10 word-based puzzles where participants were given three words and had to think of a fourth word related to them
- Pain: three pads were placed on the body and the temperature was increased on one pad and participants had to say which of the pads was active
- Memory: read 20 trigrams and try to remember as many as possible for a retrieval test after five minutes.

Explain what Lynne is likely to find with her patients.

You must refer to the function of the damaged brain lobe in your response.

(Total for Question 20 = 2 marks)

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3. Question 20 · part whole · 2 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

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4. Question 17 · part whole · 2 marks

2022 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part whole only.

17 Figure 4 shows an image of a human brain.

Complete the boxes provided with the areas of the brain.

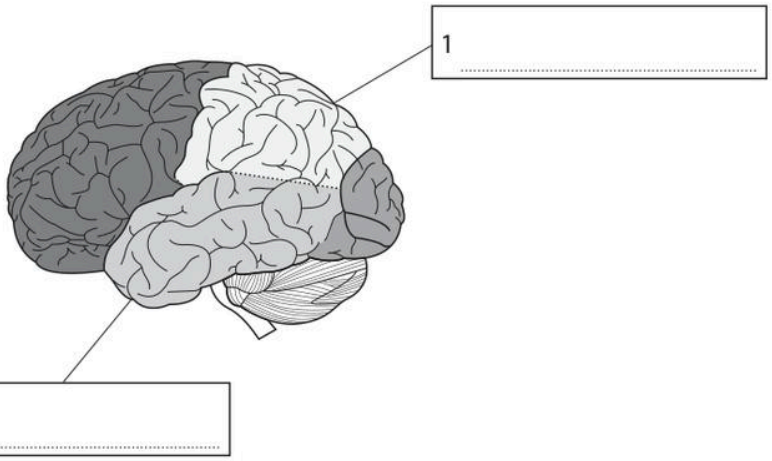


Figure 4

(Total for Question 17 = 2 marks)

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Working and answer

5. Question 16 · part whole · 2 marks

2023 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part whole only.

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16 Diogo is investigating the function of the temporal lobes. He recruits participants with and without damage to their temporal lobes to participate in his study. Diogo believes that he will better understand the function of the temporal lobes by seeing if there is any difference in the participant performance on a task.

Diogo asks his participants to listen to a simple song that he has created. He then asks them to try to sing the song out loud.

Explain what Diogo is likely to find in his study.

You should refer to the function of the temporal lobes in your answer.

(Total for Question 16 = 2 marks)

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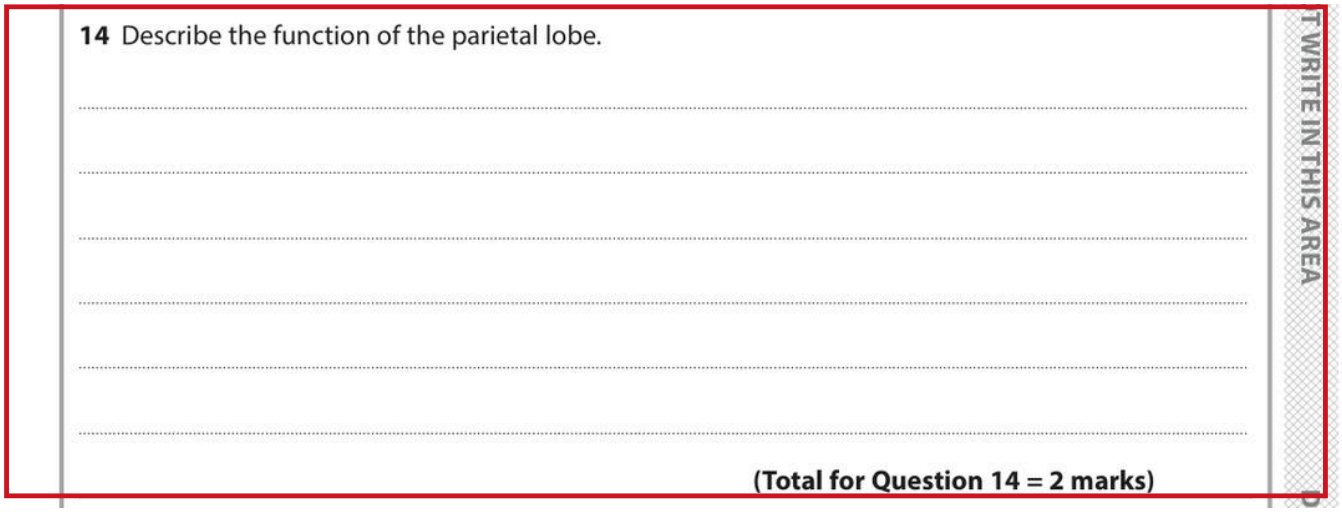
OLevels.com SCHOOL

Working and answer

6. Question 14 · part whole · 2 marks

2025 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part whole only.


14 Describe the function of the parietal lobe.

(Total for Question 14 = 2 marks)

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Working and answer

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Practice workbook · Neurons, synapses and the central nervous system

Neurons, synapses, neurotransmitters and what the CNS does.

5 question parts: 1 worked-example retry and 4 further practice parts.
Name: _____ Class: _____ Date: _____

Practise one question type at a time. Attempt the part inside the red boundary; the rest of the question and any figures are kept for context. Write your working in the answer space.

The first question is a retry of the website worked example, without its solution. Check your answers online with 'Check my answer', or ask your teacher for the answer booklet.

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Type ID: PSY-BRN-04

1. Question 20 · part whole · 2 marks

2024 JUN · Paper 01

Worked-example retry · Attempt part whole only.

20 Serinda was recently involved in a motorbike accident. A doctor is checking if her central nervous system is functioning as expected. Before the accident, Serinda had no damage to her central nervous system.

The doctor places hot and cold pads on Serinda's arms and legs. Serinda says she cannot feel the hot and cold pads on her legs. The doctor concludes Serinda has damaged her central nervous system.

Explain **one** reason why the doctor concluded this.

You should refer to the role of the central nervous system in your answer.

(Total for Question 20 = 2 marks)

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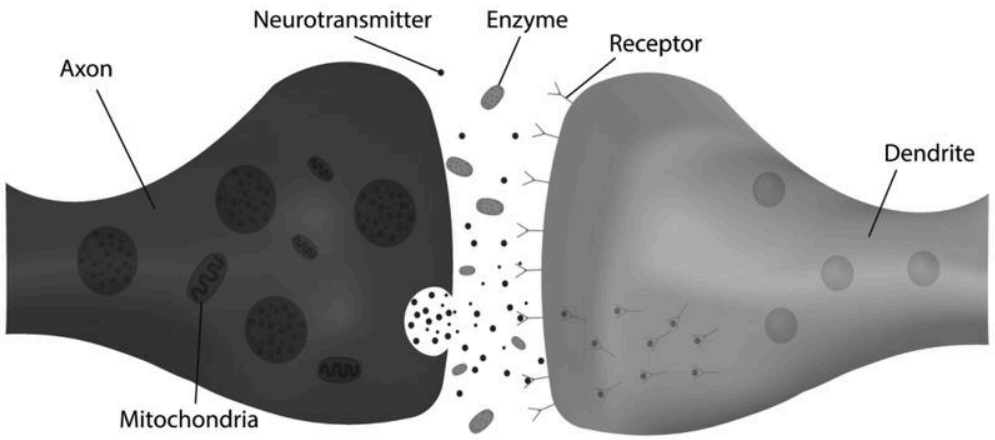
Working and answer

2. Question 15 · part whole · 2 marks

2019 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part whole only.

15 Figure 2 shows a typical synapse.



(Source: © Medical Labeled / Alamy Stock Vector)

Figure 2

Identify **two** processes that occur in **Figure 2**.

- ☒ **A** The neurotransmitters will bind to the receptor like a lock and key.
- ☒ **B** The receptors will bind to the synapse like a lock and key.
- ☒ **C** The neurotransmitters are released into the synaptic gap.
- ☒ **D** The receptors are released into the synaptic gap.
- ☒ **E** The neurotransmitters always block the receptors.

(Total for Question 15 = 2 marks)

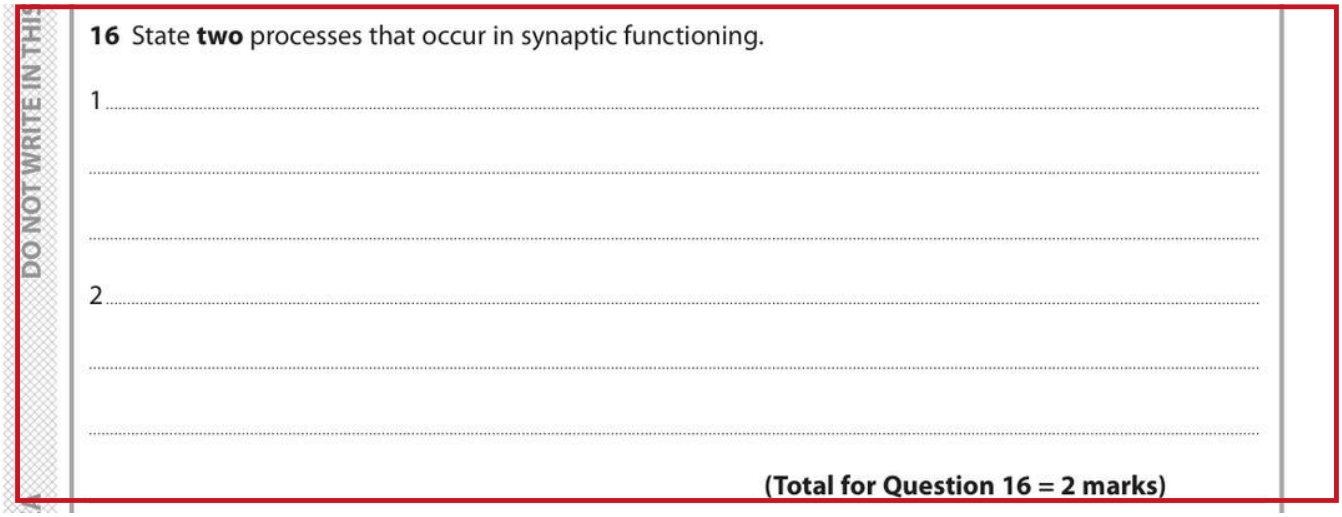
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Working and answer

3. Question 16 · part whole · 2 marks

2022 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part whole only.


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16 State **two** processes that occur in synaptic functioning.

1 .....

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2 .....

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(Total for Question 16 = 2 marks)

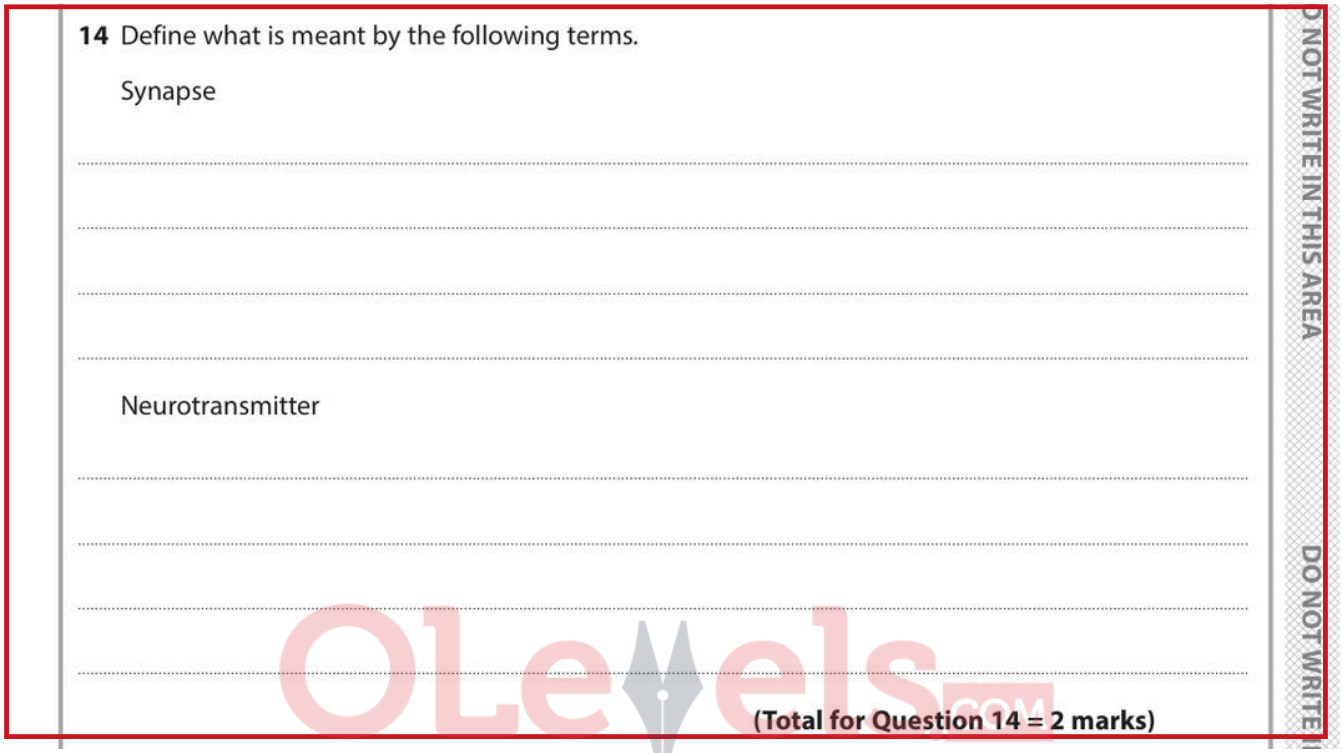
Working and answer

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4. Question 14 · part whole · 2 marks

2023 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part whole only.



14 Define what is meant by the following terms.

Synapse

Neurotransmitter

(Total for Question 14 = 2 marks)

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Working and answer

5. Question 17 · part whole · 2 marks

2024 JUN · Paper 01

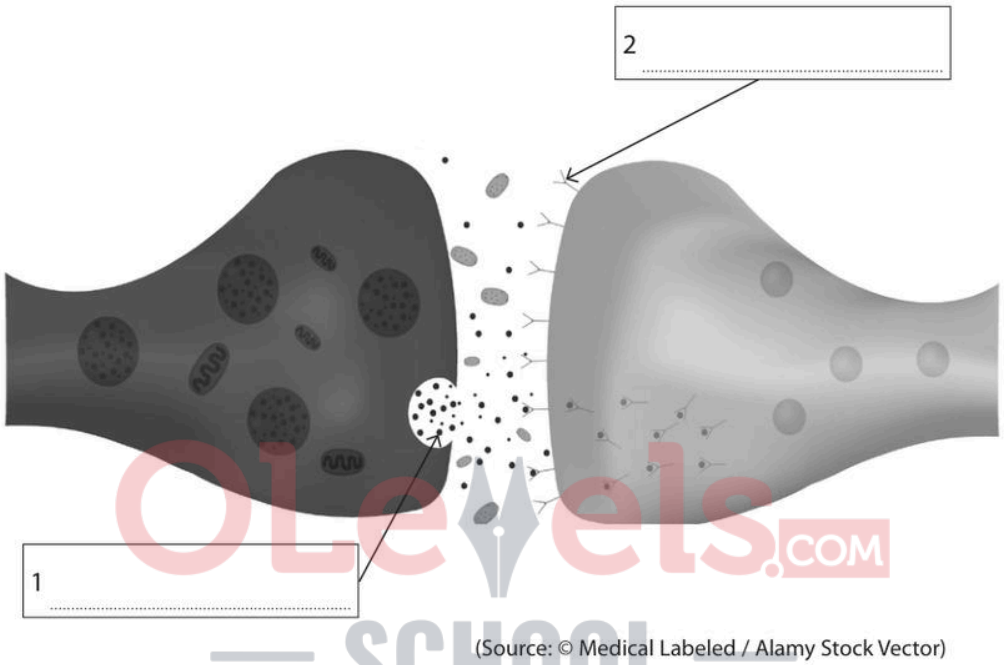
Further practice · Attempt part whole only.

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17 Figure 2 shows a typical synapse.

Complete the boxes provided with the correct labels.



(Source: © Medical Labeled / Alamy Stock Vector)

Figure 2

(Total for Question 17 = 2 marks)

OLevels.com SCHOOL

Working and answer

Practice workbook · Left and right hemispheres, corpus callosum and sex differences

Roles of the left and right hemispheres, the corpus callosum, and lateralisation as an account of sex differences.

5 question parts: 1 worked-example retry and 4 further practice parts.
Name: _____ Class: _____ Date: _____

Practise one question type at a time. Attempt the part inside the red boundary; the rest of the question and any figures are kept for context. Write your working in the answer space.

The first question is a retry of the website worked example, without its solution. Check your answers online with 'Check my answer', or ask your teacher for the answer booklet.

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Type ID: PSY-BRN-02

1. Question 19 · part a · 2 marks

2022 JUN · Paper 01

Worked-example retry · Attempt part a only.

19 Josh is investigating sex differences in spatial ability. He asks one female and one male to carry out a spatial ability map reading task. The participants have to independently navigate their way from a castle to a cake shop using the quickest route possible using a map.

(a) Explain **one** likely outcome of the map reading task.

You should refer to research evidence regarding sex differences in your answer.

(2)

(b) Explain **one** improvement that could have been made to Josh's investigation.

(2)

(Total for Question 19 = 4 marks)

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1. Question 19 · part a · 2 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

OLevels.com SCHOOL

2. Question 16 · part whole · 2 marks

2019 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part whole only.

16 Antoine has suffered a stroke, which has damaged his left hemisphere.

Explain **one** problem Antoine may experience as a result of the damage to his left hemisphere.

You should refer to the role of the left hemisphere in your answer.

(Total for Question 16 = 2 marks)

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Working and answer

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3. Question 17 · part whole · 4 marks

2019 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part whole only.

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17 Ahmed is male and enjoys competitive activities that use spatial ability, whereas Sadiah is female and enjoys cooperative activities that use language ability.

Explain **one** strength and **one** weakness of lateralisation as an explanation for the sex differences between Ahmed and Sadiah.

Strength:

Weakness:

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(Total for Question 17 = 4 marks)

3. Question 17 · part whole · 4 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

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4. Question 15 · part b · 2 marks

2020 NOV · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part b only.

15 Ishfaq is investigating the impact of damage to different parts of the brain on people's lives. He recruits a unique patient who has damage to a specific part of his corpus callosum.

The patient is asked a number of open and closed ended questions during an interview of how the condition affects his life. The patient also undergoes a number of experimental tests in the laboratory, such as being presented with an object in one hand, without being able to see the object, and being asked to name it.

(a) Explain **one** strength and **one** weakness of Ishfaq's investigation into the patient with damage to his corpus callosum.

(4)

Strength

Weakness

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4. Question 15 · part b · 2 marks

2020 NOV · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part b only.

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(b) Explain **one** problem that Ishfaq's patient may experience as a result of the damage to his corpus callosum in the experimental tasks given by Ishfaq.

You should refer to the role of the corpus callosum in your answer.

(2)

(Total for Question 15 = 6 marks)

OLevels.com SCHOOL

Working and answer

5. Question 15 · part whole · 2 marks

2023 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part whole only.

15 Describe the difference between the roles of the left hemisphere and the right hemisphere of the brain.

(Total for Question 15 = 2 marks)

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Working and answer

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Practice workbook · Damasio et al. (1994): the return of Phineas Gage

Damasio et al. (1994) reconstruction of Phineas Gage's injury: aim, procedure, findings and use.

7 question parts: 1 worked-example retry and 6 further practice parts.
Name: _____ Class: _____ Date: _____

Practise one question type at a time. Attempt the part inside the red boundary; the rest of the question and any figures are kept for context. Write your working in the answer space.

The first question is a retry of the website worked example, without its solution. Check your answers online with 'Check my answer', or ask your teacher for the answer booklet.

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Type ID: PSY-BRN-06

1. Question 16 · part b · 4 marks

2025 JUN · Paper 01

Worked-example retry · Attempt part b only.

16 Marvin is a tutor at an evening school teaching different languages. He speaks English as his first language but also speaks Spanish, French and Polish. Every evening he has classes with people of a wide variety of ages and levels of ability who have joined the school to learn a new language.

On the way home one evening, Marvin was involved in an accident which injured his brain. The doctors have said Marvin has damaged areas of his frontal lobes, including his ventromedial region and Broca's area.

(a) Explain how Marvin is likely to find the brain damage affects his life.

You should refer to Damasio et al. (1994) in your answer.

(2)

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1. Question 16 · part b · 4 marks

2025 JUN · Paper 01

Worked-example retry · Attempt part b only.

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(b) Explain **one** strength and **one** weakness of using Damasio et al. (1994) to account for the outcome of Marvin's brain damage.

(4)

Strength

Weakness

(Total for Question 16 = 6 marks)

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1. Question 16 · part b · 4 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

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2. Question 18 · part a · 2 marks

2019 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part a only.

18 Holly is interested in how damage to the pre-frontal cortex can impact on personality.

Holly asks 10 male patients who are patients at her local hospital with pre-frontal cortex damage to talk about the differences in their personality before and after the damage.

(a) Explain what Holly is likely to find in her investigation.

You should refer to a study in your answer.

(2)

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2. Question 18 · part a · 2 marks

2019 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part a only.

(b) Explain **two** improvements that could be made to Holly's study.

(4)

Improvement one:

Improvement two:

(Total for Question 18 = 6 marks)

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Working and answer

3. Question 13 · part a · 1 mark

2020 NOV · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part a only.

13 (a) State **one** aim of the Damasio et al. (1994) study.

(1)

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(b) State **one** part of the procedure used in Damasio et al. (1994).

(1)

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(c) Identify **two** findings suggested from Damasio et al.'s (1994) study.

(2)

- ☒ **A** Broca's area was undamaged
- ☒ **B** The motor cortices were damaged
- ☒ **C** The ventromedial region of the frontal lobes was damaged
- ☒ **D** None of the damage occurred in the frontal lobes
- ☒ **E** The dorsolateral region of the frontal lobes was damaged

(Total for Question 13 = 4 marks)

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Working and answer

4. Question 13 · part b · 1 mark

2020 NOV · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part b only.

13 (a) State **one** aim of the Damasio et al. (1994) study.

(1)

(b) State **one** part of the procedure used in Damasio et al. (1994).

(1)

(c) Identify **two** findings suggested from Damasio et al.'s (1994) study.

(2)

- ☒ **A** Broca's area was undamaged
- ☒ **B** The motor cortices were damaged
- ☒ **C** The ventromedial region of the frontal lobes was damaged
- ☒ **D** None of the damage occurred in the frontal lobes
- ☒ **E** The dorsolateral region of the frontal lobes was damaged

(Total for Question 13 = 4 marks)

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Working and answer

5. Question 13 · part c · 2 marks

2020 NOV · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part c only.

13 (a) State **one** aim of the Damasio et al. (1994) study.

(1)

(b) State **one** part of the procedure used in Damasio et al. (1994).

(1)

(c) Identify **two** findings suggested from Damasio et al.'s (1994) study.

(2)

- ☒ **A** Broca's area was undamaged
- ☒ **B** The motor cortices were damaged
- ☒ **C** The ventromedial region of the frontal lobes was damaged
- ☒ **D** None of the damage occurred in the frontal lobes
- ☒ **E** The dorsolateral region of the frontal lobes was damaged

(Total for Question 13 = 4 marks)

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OLevels.com SCHOOL

Working and answer

6. Question 18 · part whole · 4 marks

2021 NOV · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part whole only.

18 Allan was recently involved in a motorcycle accident.

He has damaged his frontal lobes, with specific damage in the ventromedial region and Broca's area.

Allan visited a psychologist who has predicted that in the future he will have difficulty making rational decisions, but all other functions will remain intact.

Explain **one** strength and **one** weakness of using Damasio et al.'s (1994) study as an explanation for the psychologist's prediction.

Strength

Weakness

(Total for Question 18 = 4 marks)

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6. Question 18 · part whole · 4 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

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7. Question 16 · part a · 2 marks

2025 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part a only.

16 Marvin is a tutor at an evening school teaching different languages. He speaks English as his first language but also speaks Spanish, French and Polish. Every evening he has classes with people of a wide variety of ages and levels of ability who have joined the school to learn a new language.

On the way home one evening, Marvin was involved in an accident which injured his brain. The doctors have said Marvin has damaged areas of his frontal lobes, including his ventromedial region and Broca's area.

(a) Explain how Marvin is likely to find the brain damage affects his life.

You should refer to Damasio et al. (1994) in your answer.

(2)

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7. Question 16 · part a · 2 marks

2025 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part a only.

(b) Explain **one** strength and **one** weakness of using Damasio et al. (1994) to account for the outcome of Marvin's brain damage.

(4)

Strength

Weakness

(Total for Question 16 = 6 marks)

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7. Question 16 · part a · 2 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

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Practice workbook · Sperry (1968): split-brain patients

Sperry (1968) split-brain study: sample, tasks, findings, conclusions and evaluation.

7 question parts: 1 worked-example retry and 6 further practice parts.
Name: _____ Class: _____ Date: _____

Practise one question type at a time. Attempt the part inside the red boundary; the rest of the question and any figures are kept for context. Write your working in the answer space.

The first question is a retry of the website worked example, without its solution. Check your answers online with 'Check my answer', or ask your teacher for the answer booklet.

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Type ID: PSY-BRN-03

1. Question 18 · part a · 2 marks

2022 JUN · Paper 01

Worked-example retry · Attempt part a only.

18 Hina is a split brain patient from Japan who has had the corpus callosum, which connects the two hemispheres in the brain, severed.

Hina goes to a magic show one evening. During the magic show the magician asks for a volunteer and she volunteers and has to go on stage. Whilst on stage Hina is asked to select an object from inside a bag and choose one of the objects (but keep the object inside the bag). Hina uses her left hand to pick a marble.

The magician tries to guess the object Hina has picked and writes down his answer and puts it inside an envelope. Hina is asked to say to the audience which object she picked before the contents of the envelope are revealed.

(a) Explain what Hina is likely to say.

You should refer to Sperry (1968) in your answer.

(2)

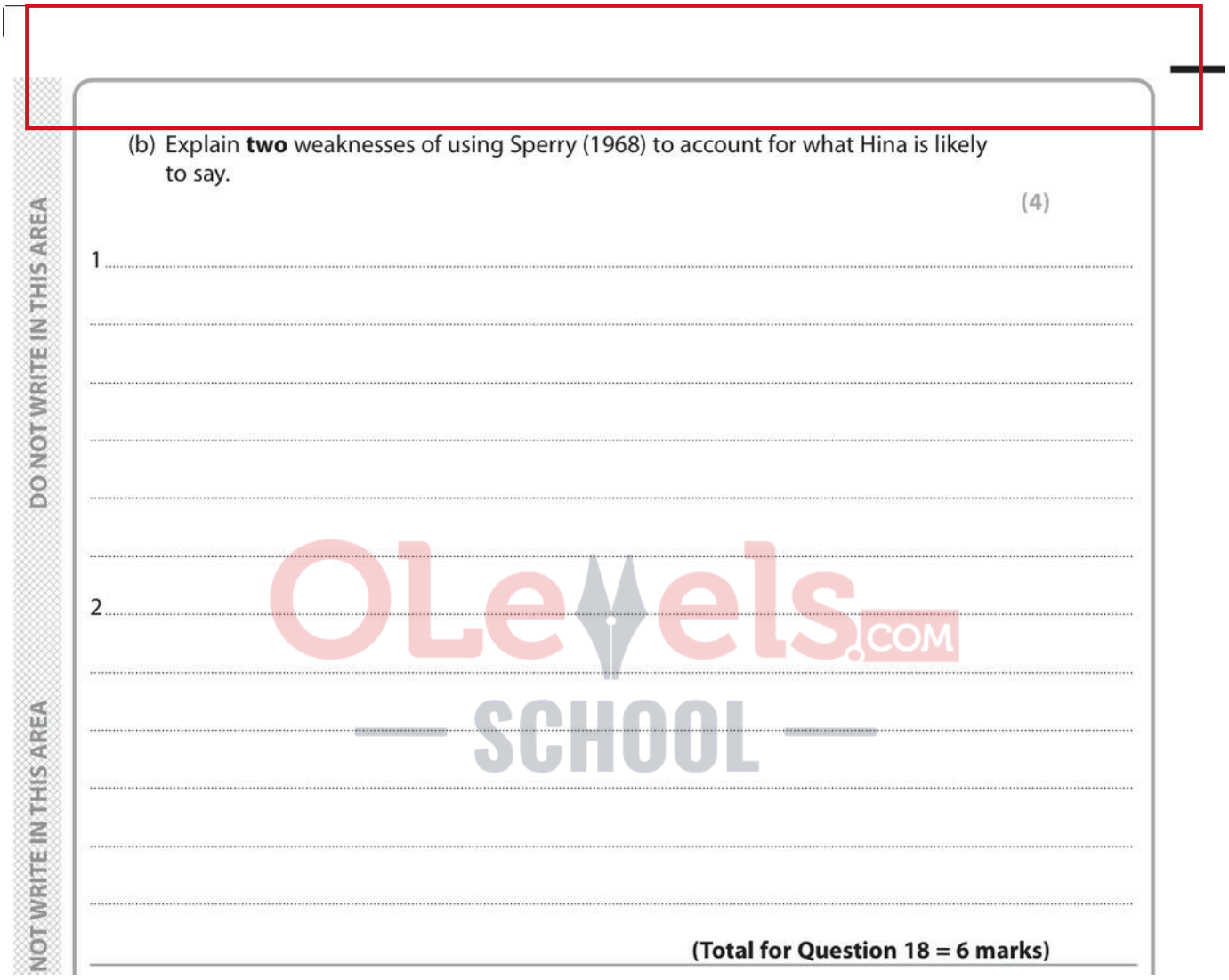
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1. Question 18 · part a · 2 marks

2022 JUN · Paper 01

Worked-example retry · Attempt part a only.



(b) Explain **two** weaknesses of using Sperry (1968) to account for what Hina is likely to say.

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(Total for Question 18 = 6 marks)

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OLevels.COM SCHOOL

Working and answer

2. Question 16 · part a · 1 mark

2021 NOV · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part a only.

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16 (a) State the number of patients Sperry (1968) reported on in his research.

(1)

(b) As part of Sperry's (1968) research, patients were asked to use their left and right hands to pick an item from a bag and name the object without seeing it.

Describe what Sperry (1968) found in this task.

(2)

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(c) Identify **one** conclusion that could be made from Sperry's (1968) research.

The left hemisphere was the primary hemisphere for:

(1)

- ☒ **A** spatial tasks
- ☒ **B** language processing
- ☒ **C** emotions
- ☒ **D** memory tasks

(Total for Question 16 = 4 marks)

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2. Question 16 · part a · 1 mark · Working and answer

Working and answer

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3. Question 16 · part b · 2 marks

2021 NOV · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part b only.

DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA

16 (a) State the number of patients Sperry (1968) reported on in his research.

(1)

(b) As part of Sperry's (1968) research, patients were asked to use their left and right hands to pick an item from a bag and name the object without seeing it.

Describe what Sperry (1968) found in this task.

(2)

(c) Identify **one** conclusion that could be made from Sperry's (1968) research.

The left hemisphere was the primary hemisphere for:

(1)

- ☒ **A** spatial tasks
- ☒ **B** language processing
- ☒ **C** emotions
- ☒ **D** memory tasks

(Total for Question 16 = 4 marks)

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3. Question 16 · part b · 2 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

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4. Question 16 · part c · 1 mark

2021 NOV · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part c only.

DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA

16 (a) State the number of patients Sperry (1968) reported on in his research.

(1)

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Describe what Sperry (1968) found in this task.

(2)

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(c) Identify **one** conclusion that could be made from Sperry's (1968) research.

The left hemisphere was the primary hemisphere for:

(1)

- ☒ **A** spatial tasks
- ☒ **B** language processing
- ☒ **C** emotions
- ☒ **D** memory tasks

(Total for Question 16 = 4 marks)

4. Question 16 · part c · 1 mark · Working and answer

Working and answer

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5. Question 18 · part b · 4 marks

2022 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part b only.

18 Hina is a split brain patient from Japan who has had the corpus callosum, which connects the two hemispheres in the brain, severed.

Hina goes to a magic show one evening. During the magic show the magician asks for a volunteer and she volunteers and has to go on stage. Whilst on stage Hina is asked to select an object from inside a bag and choose one of the objects (but keep the object inside the bag). Hina uses her left hand to pick a marble.

The magician tries to guess the object Hina has picked and writes down his answer and puts it inside an envelope. Hina is asked to say to the audience which object she picked before the contents of the envelope are revealed.

(a) Explain what Hina is likely to say.

You should refer to Sperry (1968) in your answer.

(2)

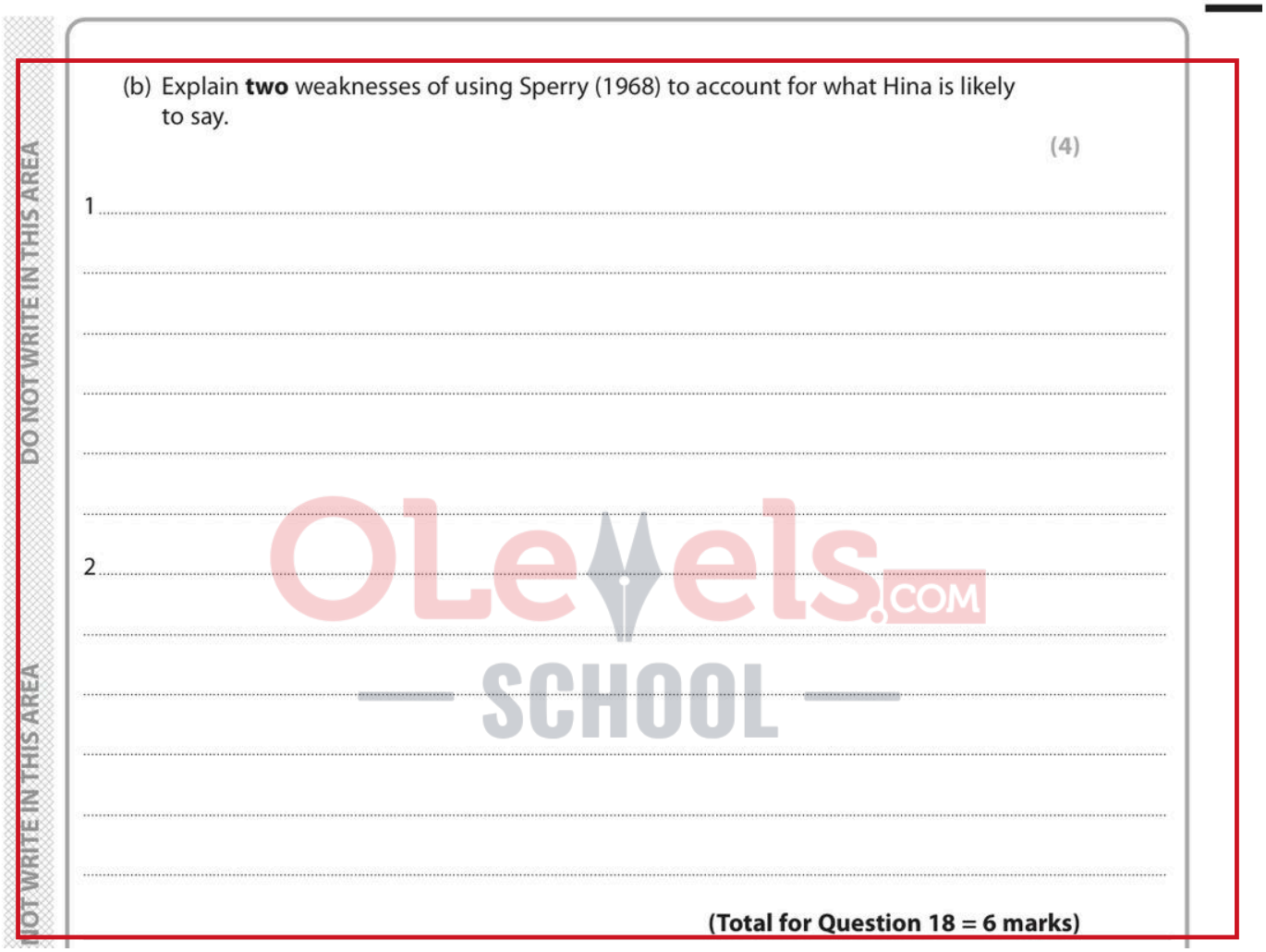
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5. Question 18 · part b · 4 marks

2022 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part b only.



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(b) Explain **two** weaknesses of using Sperry (1968) to account for what Hina is likely to say.

(4)

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2 .....

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(Total for Question 18 = 6 marks)

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5. Question 18 · part b · 4 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

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6. Question 18 · part whole · 2 marks

2023 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part whole only.

18 Amy is a psychologist investigating split brain patients who have a severed corpus callosum. Amy shows the patients a video of various dogs doing silly things, such as falling into swimming pools or dancing. The video is only presented to the right hemisphere of each patient, using specialist apparatus.

Describe what Amy is likely to find regarding the patients' reaction to the video.

You should refer to Sperry (1968) in your answer.

(Total for Question 18 = 2 marks)

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Working and answer

7. Question 15 · part a · 2 marks

2025 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part a only.

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15 (a) State **two** conclusions from Sperry (1968).

(2)

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2 .....

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(b) Explain **one** improvement that Sperry (1968) could have made to his investigation.

(2)

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(Total for Question 15 = 4 marks)

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Working and answer